Claude for ESOL Prep – Prompt Bank Handout (Teachers)

Oct 21, 2026 · @Atin

Use this with the slides: each numbered section matches a slide. All the prompts are my own. Copy the text in the boxes and fill in the bold [brackets]. Made by Atin.

Handout 1 · Set up your project (slide 4)

Paste this into your project's instructions box.

> *I teach adult ESOL in London, UK. Use UK English spelling. My learners are **[Entry 1 / Entry 2 / Entry 3 / Level 1]**. Match vocabulary and grammar to that level. In learner materials, use simple, clear, neutral language. No slang. Use real-life London contexts: work, the NHS, shopping, transport, housing, local services. For exam practice, follow ESB Skills for Life formats. Keep answers short. Give me the material, then stop. No extra versions unless I ask. Ask one question only if my request is really unclear. Worksheets: sans serif font (e.g. Arial), at least 11pt, fit on as few pages as possible. Put answer keys at the end, kept brief. In reading questions, don't reuse words from the text. Paraphrase. If I ask for a change, only change that part.*

Handout 2 · Demo 1: E1 speaking dialogue (slide 5)

> *E1 speaking practice for the ESB exam. Topic: **[home and family]**. A short dialogue where each answer leads to only one next question. Then a gap-fill version learners can complete about their own life.*

Then copy one small change, for example:

- Make it shorter. Change nothing else.
- Add a question about work. Change nothing else.
- Make the gap-fill easier. Change nothing else.

Handout 3 · Demo 2: E3 reading exam (slide 6)

> *E3 reading text, about 250 words, set in Hackney. Topic:* ***[using the library]****. Then 6 questions in ESB style: multiple choice, true/false, short answer. Answer key at the end.*

Then: *Check your questions. Do any use the same words as the text? If so, paraphrase them.*

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Handout 4 · Demo 3: second opinion on writing (slide 7)

> *This is an ESB* ***[LEVEL]*** *writing task. Would this learner pass today? Give 3 strengths and 3 things to work on, in simple words I can share.* ***[PASTE TEXT]***

Sample to paste in place of **[PASTE TEXT]** (a made-up E2 learner, so use **E2** as the level):

> *Task: Write an email to a friend about your new home. Say where it is and what it is like. Invite your friend to visit.*
>
> *Hi Maria, How are you? I am write to tell you about my new flat. I moved last month to Hackney, near to Mare Street. The flat have two bedroom and a small kitchen. Is very quiet and the neighbours are friendly. There is a big park next my building, I go there every morning with my son. Can you come to visit me on saturday? We can cook togheter and go to the market. Love, Amina*

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Handout 5 · Your turn: my prompt bank (slide 8)

Prompts I've built up and used over several years of ESOL teaching, updated for Claude. Made by Atin.

Click a prompt to jump to it. Only change the **bold [brackets]**.

I want…	Jump to
Writing practice	Writing tasks · Emails · Story starters
Grammar or vocabulary	Grammar worksheet · Grammar from a text · Vocabulary · Gap-fill · Quiz
Reading	Comprehension questions · Leaflet · UK culture · Scanning a website
Listening	Dialogue · Short talk
Speaking	Roleplay · Pronunciation · Picture description
Feedback	Error correction · SMART targets

5a · Writing

Writing tasks

Exam-style writing practice on real-life topics.

> ***[LEVEL]*** *writing practice in ESB style. Write 5 writing tasks on real-life topics for London-based learners. Give a word count that suits* ***[LEVEL]****. Example: You work for a website about healthy living. Write to readers with advice on healthy food and exercise.*

Email writing

Practical emails with a model answer.

> ***[LEVEL]** email writing. Write 3 email tasks for real situations, e.g. asking your manager for time off. Say what to include, e.g. the reason and dates. Add one model email at **[LEVEL]**.*

Story starters

Simple creative writing.

> ***[LEVEL]** creative writing. Write 5 short story starters about everyday London life. Example: Maria found a wallet on the bus. What did she do next?*

5b · Grammar and vocabulary

Grammar worksheet

Self-access practice on one grammar point.

> ***[LEVEL]** self-access worksheet on **[GRAMMAR POINT]**. Include: 1. a short reading text using the grammar, 2. a simple explanation, 3. five comprehension questions, 4. two practice exercises. Answer key at the end.*

Grammar from a text

Turn any text into a grammar lesson.

> *Find the grammar in the text below that will most challenge **[LEVEL]** learners. Make a worksheet with: 1. a simple explanation, 2. two controlled exercises, 3. a short writing task using it. Answer key at the end. Text: **[PASTE TEXT]***

Vocabulary from a text

Key words, meanings and synonyms.

> *Pick 8 key words from the text below for **[LEVEL]** learners. Make a table: word, simple meaning, synonym. Then write 5 questions like "Which word means …?". Answers at the end. Text: **[PASTE TEXT]***

Gap-fill (cloze)

Vocabulary and grammar in context.

> *Make a gap-fill from the text below for **[LEVEL]** learners. Remove 10 key nouns, verbs, adjectives or adverbs. Use the format (1) _____. Give the removed words as a word bank in alphabetical order. Text: **[PASTE TEXT]***

Multiple-choice quiz

Ready for Microsoft Forms or Quizizz. Turn on "Shuffle answers" when you import it, as a is always correct.

> ***[LEVEL]** quiz: 10 multiple-choice questions on **[TOPIC OR GRAMMAR POINT]**. Four options each (a–d), with a as the correct answer. Plain list, ready to paste into Microsoft Forms.*

5c · Reading and listening

Comprehension questions

Tests understanding, not word-matching.

> *Write 10 **[LEVEL]** comprehension questions on the text below, in ESB style. Don't use the same words as the text in the questions: paraphrase. Answers in a table at the end. Text: **[PASTE TEXT]***

Leaflet

Skimming and scanning a structured text.

> ***[LEVEL]** reading: a leaflet about **[TOPIC]**, set in London. Clear headings with 3–5 short sentences under each. Add realistic but made-up contact details. Then 5 scanning questions, answers at the end.*

UK culture reading

Cultural knowledge plus reading practice.

> ***[LEVEL]** reading text about a UK cultural event, e.g. **[Bonfire Night]**. Add 5 comprehension questions that paraphrase the text, and a vocabulary table with simple meanings. Answers at the end.*

Scanning a website

Paste the page text rather than a link. It's more reliable.

> *Below is text from **[WEBSITE NAME]**. Write 8 **[LEVEL]** scanning questions, each asking for one specific detail. Answers in a table. Text: **[PASTE TEXT]***

Listening dialogue

Read it aloud yourself, or play it through the classroom speakers with a text-to-speech tool.

> ***[LEVEL]** listening: a natural dialogue between two people in London about **[TOPIC, e.g. seeing a GP]**. Length to suit **[LEVEL]**. Label lines Speaker 1 and Speaker 2. Include realistic prices or times. Then 6 questions, answers in a table.*

Listening: short talk

Exam-style listening for detail.

> ***[LEVEL]** listening: a short talk by a manager welcoming people to **[PLACE OR SERVICE]**. Include realistic names, activities and costs. Length to suit **[LEVEL]**. Then 6 questions with 1–3 word answers.*

5d · Speaking

Roleplay

Real-world speaking practice.

> ***[LEVEL]** roleplay: **[SITUATION, e.g. asking for directions]**. Include a model dialogue, key vocabulary and follow-up questions.*

Pronunciation

No phonetic symbols, so Entry learners can use it.

> ***[LEVEL]** pronunciation: 10 short sentences practising **[SOUNDS, e.g. th / v / w]**. Add minimal pairs (e.g. ship / sheep) and simple spelling guides learners can read. No phonetic symbols.*

Picture description

Claude won't make the pictures. Use your own photos on the projector.

> ***[LEVEL]** speaking: picture description tasks for photos of **[SCENES, e.g. a market, a GP waiting room]**. For each, give 3–4 questions and useful words. Focus on the present continuous.*

5e · Feedback on learner work

Error correction table

Clear feedback learners can review.

> *Check the learner text below. Make a table: learner's sentence with mistakes in bold | type of error (e.g. tense, word order, spelling) | corrected sentence. Only include rows with errors. Text: **[PASTE TEXT]***

SMART targets

> *Here are notes on my **[LEVEL]** learners. Write 4–5 SMART targets for each learner, simple enough for them to read. Notes: **[PASTE NOTES]***

See what's possible: made by Atin

A few things I've built with Claude. Have a look for ideas.

What	Have a look
Interactive lessons	E2 Past Simple · Freecycle reading · Hackney Bugle
The graffiti lesson	Worksheet · Error hunt · Poster
Mobile games	Grammar Blast · Verb Catcher

Sample printable worksheet: the graffiti lesson as a print-ready handout. Two sides per learner, plus one teacher page with notes and answers.

[image: E3 Mixed Tenses – Graffiti Warning Poster – Worksheet (PDF)]

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